

Information Is Currency. Inherit the Deal.

Gather first. Recommend second. The close is inherited from the information stage — not pushed at the end.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 Information is currency**
Gather before you pitch. Buying habits repeat.
- 02 Statement questions**
Convert direct questions into statements. Defence stays down.
- 03 Have a thesis**
Walk in 85% validated. Update as evidence comes in.
- 04 Active listening callbacks**
Three explicit repeats of the buyer's words per pitch.
- 05 Inherit the close**
90% info, 10% close. The yes is decided before you ask.
- 06 The ask-for-help close**
Frame the recommendation as collaboration, not pressure.
- 07 Daily reference card**
Print and pin. Read before every pitch.

Information is currency.

Buying habits repeat. The more you know before you pitch, the easier the close becomes.

WHO BUILT IT

Reveals the buyer's price tier and opens up a list of similar prospects.

WHAT THEY PAID

Sizes the budget for the next purchase. Use statement form to surface it.

WHO REFERRED THEM

Their network is your next pipeline.

WHO THEIR COMPETITORS ARE

Tells you what they actually care about.

THE PRINCIPLE

Buying habits repeat. The more the rep learns about how the buyer made their last purchase, the easier the next one becomes.

Statement questions.

Direct questions trigger defence. Statements invite the buyer to confirm or correct — which is more revealing.

DIRECT <i>"How much did you pay for the website?"</i>	→	STATEMENT "You must have paid heaps — it looks fantastic."
DIRECT <i>"Who built your website?"</i>	→	STATEMENT "It's beautifully built. I'm just trying to understand the framework — do you remember roughly who?"
DIRECT <i>"What's your budget?"</i>	→	STATEMENT "Some clients in your space invest around \$1,500–\$2,500 for what you're after."
DIRECT <i>"Are you the decision-maker?"</i>	→	STATEMENT "You sound like you're the one calling the shots here."
DIRECT <i>"Do you know anyone else who could use this?"</i>	→	STATEMENT "You strike me as someone with a strong network in this industry."

WHY IT WORKS

Direct questions trigger defence — "I can't remember" usually means "none of your business." Statements invite correction without cost.

Walk in 85% validated.

Have a working thesis before the call. Use the conversation to validate — or update — not to improvise from scratch.

BEFORE THE CALL

01

Review industry, size, public info. Form a working view of who they are and how they'll buy.

DURING THE CALL

02

Ask in statement form. Listen for confirmations and contradictions. Update the thesis as evidence comes in.

MID-PITCH

03

If a checkpoint breaks the thesis, change tack. Don't push a recommendation that no longer fits.

END OF CALL

04

The recommendation should feel inevitable to the buyer — because it lines up with everything they've told you.

THE TEST

After every pitch, score your thesis against reality. The gap is your prep target for next week.

Active listening callbacks.

Three explicit repeats of the buyer's own words per pitch. Less than that, they feel unheard. More, it sounds rehearsed.

THE FORMULA

"One of the things you told me is X... so the recommendation I'm about to make is built around that."

EXAMPLES IN PITCH FORM

01 Tying the recommendation to their stated goal

"You said you want to expand — so the recommendation I'm making is built around that, not around hitting a number for me."

02 Tying the recommendation to a problem they named

"You mentioned the website hadn't been touched for years, and you're getting work mostly through referrals — that's the exact gap we're going to fix."

03 Tying the recommendation to a comparison they made

"You told me your competitors are winning work you're not even bidding on — let me show you what their keywords look like vs yours."

04 Tying the close to their decision style

"You said you don't like making decisions in a rush — I won't push for one today. Just have a look at the proposal."

Inherit the close.

90% information. 10% close. The yes is decided before you ask for it.

CHASE THE CLOSE

*Rep spends 10% on info, 90% on the close.
Trying to push the buyer over the line.*

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE:

- Pressure tactics. Multiple price drops.
- Generic recommendation that doesn't match what was said.
- Buyer feels rushed and pushes back.
- "Let me think about it" becomes the default exit.
- Close conversion stays at industry-average.

INHERIT THE CLOSE

*Rep spends 90% on info, 10% on the close.
The recommendation matches what was said.
Close is a confirmation.*

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE:

- Conversation, not interrogation.
- Recommendation feels built for the buyer.
- Buyer agrees because it matches their words back.
- Close becomes "sounds like you're ready for the next step."
- Conversion lifts dramatically.

THE SHIFT

The close is decided during discovery. If it feels hard at the end, the info stage was incomplete. Go back and fill the gap.

The ask-for-help close.

Invert the power dynamic. Ask the buyer to help you decide which option fits best.

THE LINE

"Look — I've got some options here. I'm not sure where to go from here, I know what I'd like to do, so I'll present that first. Let's work together on figuring out the right solution."

WHY IT WORKS

01 "Not sure where to go" signals humility

Buyers tense up when they sense a sales push. The phrase removes the push without giving up the recommendation.

02 Anchoring + flexibility in one move

Presenting the preferred option first anchors the conversation. Framing it as "what I'd like to do" leaves room for the buyer to push back without losing face.

03 Co-ownership of the decision

Working together means the buyer ends up co-owning the choice — and a co-owned yes is much harder to walk back from.

04 It works even when they push back

If the buyer suggests a different option, the rep mirrors it. The collaboration is real — and it still closes the deal.

Daily reference card.

Print and pin. Read before every pitch.

DO · EVERY PITCH

- Walk in with a working thesis.
- Convert questions to statements.
- Listen for buying patterns in the first 5 minutes.
- Repeat back the buyer's words 3 times in the pitch.
- Recommend what matches what they said.
- Use the ask-for-help close.
- Walk back value, not price, if pushed.
- Make the close feel inherited, not imposed.

DON'T · EVER

- Don't ask direct interrogation-style questions.
- Don't accept "I can't remember" as the end.
- Don't pitch before you've gathered.
- Don't drop the price when you can drop the scope.
- Don't push a recommendation that doesn't fit.
- Don't ask "are you ready to buy?" — too binary.
- Don't treat the buyer's pattern as theirs alone.
- Don't sound rehearsed — keep the callbacks natural.

WATCH-OUTS

- Buyer's "I can't remember" hiding real info.
- Generic claims with no buyer-specific evidence.
- Thesis you're unwilling to update mid-call.
- Recommendation that exceeds what was said.
- Active listening that sounds parroted.
- Trying to close before discovery is complete.
- Direct discounts that hurt long-term margin.
- Pitches without three callback moments.

THE ONE-LINER

her first. Recommend second. Inherit the close. Statements not questions. Walk the value, not the price.